## CHINESE PLANS

After the clash on the Nam Ka Chu on 20 October, the Chinese had rather effortlessly pushed the Indian troops back to the south of Tawang Chu. The Chinese high command was fully aware of all the changes that were taking place on the Indian side as Chinese Intelligence agencies had set up a web of agents over the last few years to monitor and report on all Indian activity. There was enough reason to suspect that the primitive communication set-up of the Indian Army in NEFA was also compromised and not only were the Chinese listening in, they were also inserting bogus messages at key moments into the chain of command, which helped further unnerve and confuse the Indian commanders.

In 1993 and 1994, two important books were published: the first, *True History of China Border War*, written in the old Chinese script, was authored by Professor Yan Xun of the National Defence University of Beijing; and the second, *China's War of Self Defensive Counter Attack with India*, also written in Chinese, was published by the Academy of Military Sciences. Apart from giving some details of the operations from the Chinese perspective, both these books reveal the extent to which the Chinese had information about Indian deployment, their strengths and weaknesses, and an almost uncanny psychoanalysis of Indian commanders. Almost all Indian accounts, including those of Brigadiers John Dalvi and Monty Palit, mention this fact. Tashi Sonam, the Tawang-based IB agent during the 1962 clash, was categorical: 'The Chinese knew everything, Indian deployment almost to the section and platoon level was known to them. Sometimes they knew what the Indians were going to do even before the decision was taken.'

The head of the Central Military Affairs Commission (CMAC), General Liu Bocheng, was determined to avoid a face-to-face confrontation with the Indian troops. Towards this end, the Chinese plan for phase two of the operations (which started on 17 November) hinged on the Indians deciding to dig in at Se-la. On 23 October, when the decision to abandon Tawang had been taken, both the Eastern Army Commander, Bogey Sen, and BGS IV Corps, Brigadier K. K. Singh, had ordered the troops to fall back on Bomdila as per the Thorat Plan. In fact, at that stage, Bogey Sen had boasted to the political officer, Nari Rustomji, during the lull between the two phases of the war: 'We've got those bastards where we want them now. Just let them move one step forward, and they'll get such a thrashing they'll